the *Washington Post*. Columnists belittled Snowden's background, calling him a loser and a dropout. David Brooks of the *New York Times* mocked his lack of a college degree. Bob Woodward, an investigative journalist who had been a key figure in the Watergate scandal that led to the end of Richard M. Nixon's presidency in 1974, said in a TV interview, "[Snowden] clearly broke the law. . . . I certainly wouldn't call him [a] hero."[3]

Even leaders in the technology industry, those most negatively affected by NSA surveillance programs, were critical of Snowden. Bill Gates, founder of Microsoft,

PUBLIC OPINION ABOUT SNOWDEN

Soon after the first leaked documents were made public, a poll conducted by the Pew Research Center in June 2013 found 54 percent of Americans believed Snowden should be criminally prosecuted, whereas 38 percent believed he should not be prosecuted. A Gallup poll also taken in June 2013 found 44 percent of Americans believed Snowden was right to share documents with the press, whereas 42 percent thought he was wrong to do so.[4]

Five months later, in November 2013, a *Washington Post*–ABC poll showed by a margin of approximately two to one, 60 percent of respondents believed Snowden's disclosures had hurt US national security.[5] A June 2014 poll by Rasmussen Reports, taken after an interview Snowden gave to NBC television, found 31 percent viewed Snowden favorably, whereas 48 percent viewed him unfavorably.[6] A June 2014 *60 Minutes/Vanity Fair* poll found 54 percent of respondents thought Snowden had not acted ethically, whereas 27 percent thought he had acted ethically. Nineteen percent of people did not know.[7]

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